Leia George

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EDUCATION

Case Western Reserve University School of Medicine, Cleveland, Ohio Spring 2025
Master of Science Degree, Medical Physiology and Biophysics

Baylor University, Waco, Texas Fall 2021
Bachelor of Science Degree, Biology and Medical Humanities

MANUSCRIPTS

(*Indicates equal authorship)

[5] **George, L.**, Kilshaw, R., & Bozzay, M. L. (in preparation). The Short-Term Persistence and Resolution of Suicidal Ideation: An Ecological Momentary Assessment Study

[4] **George, L**., Ashrafioun, L., Stecker, T., Cho, G. Y., Ko, H., Daruwala, S., Hiser, J., & Allan, N. P. (under review). Changes in alcohol use in a trial of cognitive behavioral therapy for perceived social isolation (CBT-PSI) among adults with opioid use disorder and elevated loneliness. *Journal of Affective Disorders*.

[3] *Scott, Z., ***George, L.**, Cho, G., Ko, H., Irvin, S., Cai, X., Pan, X., Bryan, C., Allan, N. P., & Bozzay, M. L. (revise and resubmit). Study design and protocol for optimizing crisis response plan for suicide prevention. *BMJ Open*.

[2] Bozzay, M. L., Neufeld, B., **George, L**., Turner, J., Gorka, S., Langenecker, S., Crawford, T., Westlund Schreiner, M., Forney, J., & Wastler, H. (under review). Does drinking bridge the gap? How recent alcohol use moderates the acute association between suicidal ambivalence and ideation.

[1] Cho, G. Y., Allan, N., **George, L**., Bozzay, M., Ashrafioun, L., & Stecker, T. (under review). From beliefs to behavior: Examining Theory of Planned Behavior mechanisms of mental health treatment initiation across ethnoracial backgrounds. *Suicide and Life-Threatening Behavior.*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations

[2] Cho, G. Y., Ko, H., **George, L.**, Scott, Z., Bozzay, M., & Allan, N. (2026, April). Patterns and predictors of crisis response plan use following a suicidal crisis. In M. Bozzay (Chair), Crisis response planning: Clinical considerations for treatment delivery and patient plan use in daily life. Symposium presented at the *Annual Suicide Research Symposium*, Virtual.

[1] Cho, G. Y., **George, L.**, & Daruwala, S. E. (2025, November). Economic racism and suicide risk: Building equity through brief, culturally responsive interventions. Workshop presented at the *Ohio Psychological Association Multicultural Conference*, Columbus, OH.

Poster Presentations

[17] **George, L.**, Kilshaw, R., Markley, A., Saltzman, E., Scott, Z. & Bozzay, M. (2027, March). Differentiating suicidal ideation persistence from resolution using EMA of negative affect and suicide cognitions. Poster presentation submitted to the annual *Suicide Research Symposium*, Virtual.

[16] Scott, Z., Saltzman, E., Markley, A., **George, L.**, Treangen, N., Bozzay, M., & Kilshaw, R. (2027, March). Does Neighborhood Safety Moderate the Link between Social Disconnection and Suicide? Poster presentation submitted to the annual *Suicide Research Symposium*, Virtual.

[15] **George, L.**, Allan, N., Gorka, S., Stecker, T., & Ashrafioun, L. (2026, November). Testing loneliness as a mechanism of change: Effects of CBT-PSI on alcohol use among individuals with opioid use disorder. Poster presentation accepted for the annual meeting of the *Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies*, Baltimore, MD.

[14] **George, L.**, Scott, Z., Cho, G., Ko, H., Bozzay, M., & Allan, N. (2026, November). What does it mean for suicidal ideation to persist? Comparing person-specific spikes and sustained presence in momentary suicidal ideation. Poster presentation accepted for the annual meeting of the *Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies*, Suicide and Self-Injury Special Interest Group, Baltimore, MD.

[13] Scott, Z., Bozzay, M., Hiser, J., Cho, G., **George, L.**, Ko, H., & Allan, N. (2026, November). Positive coping after discharge from an inpatient stay: Examining the role of physical activity among patients with suicide risk. Poster presentation accepted for the annual meeting of the *Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies*, Baltimore, MD.

[12] **George, L.**, Schmidt, B., Sheffler, J., Suhr, J., Markley, A., & Allan, N. (2026, October). Ecological momentary assessment of anxiety and cognitive function in older adults with MCI and mild ADRD: Evidence for incremental validity. Poster presentation accepted for the *National Academy of Neuropsychology* Annual Conference, Chicago, IL.

[11] Ko, H., **George, L.**, Irvin, S., Markley, A., Sabbagh, T., Scott, A., Scott, Z., Sims, S., Stratton, K., Williams, K., Yurichak, H., Alrjub, F., Cones, M., Fuller, A., & Allan, N. (2026, October). Main outcomes for a peer-delivered pilot randomized trial targeting anxiety sensitivity, intolerance of uncertainty, and drinking risk in college students. Poster presentation accepted for the annual meeting of the *Society for Research in Psychopathology*, Columbus, OH.

[10] Scott, Z., Markley, A., **George, L.**, Cho, G., Ko, H., Bozzay, M., & Allan, N. (2026, October). Anxiety sensitivity social concern moderates the cross-lagged effects of social engagement and suicidal intent in high-risk adults. Poster presentation accepted for the annual meeting of the *Society for Research in Psychopathology*, Columbus, OH.

[9] **George, L.**, Scott, Z., Markley, A., Saltzman, E., Armey, M., & Bozzay, M. (2026, September). Eveningness, alcohol use, and suicide risk among high-risk psychiatric inpatients. Poster presented at the annual *Suicide Prevention Conference*, Columbus, OH.

[8] Scott, Z., **George, L.**, Markley, A., Saltzman, E., Armey, M., & Bozzay, M. (2026, September). Night owls and nightmares: Examining chronotype as a moderator of the nightmare-suicidality relationship. Poster presented at the annual *Suicide Prevention Conference*, Columbus, OH.

[7] Markley, A., Scott, Z., **George, L.**, Saltzman, E., Armey, M., & Bozzay, M. (2026, September). Chronotype differences in emotional reactivity: ERP evidence from high-risk psychiatric patients. Poster presented at the annual *Suicide Prevention Conference*, Columbus, OH.

[6] Saltzman, E., Markley, A., Scott, Z., **George, L.**, Armey, M., & Bozzay, M. (2026, September). Suicidal desire: Do perceived burdensomeness and thwarted belongingness moderate the relationship between nightmares and suicide? Poster presented at the annual *Suicide Prevention Conference*, Columbus, OH.

[5] **George, L.**, Schmidt, B., Sheffler, J., Suhr, J., Markley, A., & Allan, N. (2026, July). Digital phenotyping of anxiety-related cognitive distress using ecological momentary assessment. Poster presented at the *Computational Psychiatry Conference*, New Haven, CT.

[4] **George, L.**, Scott, Z., Markley, A., Saltzman, E., Armey, M., & Bozzay, M. L. (2026, April). Do chronotypes moderate the relationship between substance use and suicide? Poster presented at the *Annual Suicide Research Symposium*, Virtual.

[3] Scott, Z., **George, L.**, Markley, A., Saltzman, E., Armey, M., & Bozzay, M. (2026, April). Do chronotypes moderate the relationship between nightmares and suicide attempts? Poster presentation accepted for the *Annual Suicide Research Symposium*, Virtual.

[2] Markley, A. E., Scott, Z., **George, L.**, Saltzman, E., Armey, M., & Bozzay, M. L. (2026, April). Relationships between chronotype, emotional reactivity, and suicidal ideation: An ERP-based investigation. Presentation accepted for the *Annual Suicide Research Symposium*, Virtual.

[1] Saltzman, E., Markley, A., Scott, Z., **George, L.**, Armey, M., & Bozzay, M. (2026, April). Perceived burdensomeness and thwarted belongingness as moderators in the relationship between nightmares and suicide. Poster presented at the 5th Annual Virtual Suicide Research Symposium.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

The Ohio State Wexner Medical Center, Department of Psychiatry & Behavioral Health
Principal Investigator: Melanie Bozzay, PhD & Nicholas Allan, PhD
Project Coordinator for Advanced Resilience and Coping Study (R01MH136286) Spring 2025 – Present

- Coordinated day-to-day operations for an NIMH-funded R01 study, including ARC stand-up meetings, project coordination, study workflows, and multidisciplinary team collaboration.
- Administered structured clinical interviews and suicide risk assessments (MINI, C-SSRS, SITBI, MSSI, and THI) directly to patients in an inpatient psychiatric setting; received training in suicide risk assessment and recruited, consented, and enrolled study participants.
- Managed REDCap databases and developed ecological momentary assessment (EMA) batteries using Catalyst by MetricWire; and wrote Python scripts to process wearable sensor data and support data preprocessing and quality monitoring.
- Prepared IRB applications and modifications, developed SOPs, and resolved participant, protocol, and workflow-related issues under clinical and research supervision.
- Collaborated with clinicians, faculty, and research staff across the medical center and organized a book drive for inpatient psychiatry patients.

Principal Investigator: Nicholas Allan, PhD
Clinical Research Assistant for ASTRA (R01AG077569) Winter 2026 – Present

- Conducted participant-facing interventions for an NIAAA-funded R01 study and supported day-to-day study operations.
- Trained in and administered CAST and HET interventions according to study protocols.
- Administered neuropsychological assessments of memory, executive functioning, and attention, as well as interoceptive exposure exercises targeting stress sensitivity.
- Participated in clinical supervision with licensed clinical neuropsychologists to support intervention and assessment fidelity.
- Conducted secondary analyses using study data, including [add specific research question, methods, or manuscript/poster details].

Louis Stokes Cleveland Department of Veterans Affairs Medical Center
Principal Investigator: James Overholser, PhD
Graduate Research Assistant Fall 2024-May 2025

- Conducted patient recruitment and screening for a clinical research study on depression and suicide prevention, ensuring adherence to eligibility criteria through comprehensive review of patient medical records
- Obtained informed consent, explaining study protocols and addressing patient concerns to ensure understanding and compliance.
- Contributed to data collection efforts by documenting patient demographics and responses for quantitative analysis.
- Supported the research team in investigating the interplay between depression, suicidal ideation, and ambivalence in a veteran population, aimed at advancing mental health interventions.
- Reviewed current journal articles and discussed advances in suicidology, depression, and clinical psychology with the Principal Investigator weekly.

Office of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusive Excellence, CWRU School of Medicine
Supervisor: Adrianne Fletcher, PhD
Graduate Student Assistant Fall 2023 - Winter 2024

- Created reports for executive leadership in the Office of the Dean and coordinated/created diversity and inclusion events.
- Disseminated diversity engagement survey results across the entire school by creating comprehensive data reports and visually compelling data visualizations to effectively communicate key findings.

Baylor University, Water Quality and Ecotoxicology Lab
Principal Investigator: Bryan Brooks, PhD
Research Assistant Fall 2019 - Fall 2020

- Assisted with experiments, collected samples on zebrafish, and maintained lab inventory.
- Conducted literature reviews to support research on environmental toxicology and human and ecological health, including pharmaceuticals and other contaminants of emerging concern in aquatic environments.
- Participated in experimental setups and protocols, including PCR lab work and data analysis.

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Interventional Pain & Recovery Center
An addiction and pain management clinic specializing in holistic treatments for diverse patients in the Metropolitan Houston area.
Clinical Senior Team Member Summer 2021 - Fall 2022

- Interviewed patients, collected patient histories, prescribed medication, and triaged them.
- Administered Medication-Assisted Treatment (Buprenorphine Injections) for addiction patients
- Handled administrative tasks: coordinated with insurance companies, communicated with other doctors' offices, and obtained approvals for doctor orders.
- Coordinated patient appointments and completed patient notes using EMR, communicated with pharmaceutical representatives and collaborated with the administration team
- Shadowed the doctor and discussed peer-reviewed research with the clinical team

Meyers Clinic
Senior Intern Spring 2018 – Spring 2021

- Triaged patients, took vital signs, and provided medication
- Conducted administrative work: completed insurance checks and assisted patients with paperwork

LEADERSHIP & STUDENT INVOLVEMENT

Cleveland Student Housing Association Non-Profit
Housing Cooperative Leadership Team Fall 2023 – 2025

- Member of the executive leadership team and executive committee, representing the organization within the graduate school and in the Cleveland community

Baylor Student Health Advisory Council
Student Health Advisor Spring 2020 – Spring 2021

- Collaborated with the Baylor Health Center and Counseling Center on wellness projects
- Collected feedback and implemented student-wide support for the health center

American Student Medical Association
Medical Humanities Committee Leader Spring 2018 - Fall 2020

- Organized and led discussions on medical ethics and humanities for student participants monthly
- Organized panel discussions across the Waco community

ADVANCED TRAINING

- **Programming Skills**: R, Python, JupyterLab, OSU Code Club
- **Research/Clinical Platforms**: REDCap, Qualtrics, Gorilla Experiment Builder, Epic/IHIS, SONA, Google Health (Fitbit)
- **Ecological Momentary Assessment (EMA) Platforms**: Catalyst by MetricWire
- **Regulatory & Research Administration Platforms**: Huron IRB, National Institute of Mental Health Data Archive (NDA)

- **Clinical Training**: Safety Planning Intervention, Cognitive Anxiety Sensitivity Treatment (CAST)

ASSESSMENTS

STANDARDIZED INTERVIEWS

- Mini International Neuropsychiatric Interview (MINI)
- Columbia Suicide Severity Rating Scale (C-SSRS)
- Modified Scale for Suicide Ideation (MSSI)
- Self-Injurious Thoughts and Behaviors Interview (SITBI)
- Treatment History Interview (THI)

NEURO-PSYCHOLOGICAL TESTS ADMINISTERED

- Repeatable Battery for the Assessment of Neurological Status (RBANS)
- Delis-Kaplan Executive Function System (DK-EFS)
- Wechsler Adult Intelligence Scale (WAIS-IV) Digit Span Backward

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- **Computational Psychiatry** – Member (April 2026 – present)
- **Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies** – Member (August 2026 – present)
- **Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapist Suicide and Self-Injurious Student Group** - Member (August 2026 - present)
- **National Academy of Neuropsychology –** Member (September 2026 – present)

ACADEMIC REFERENCES

Available upon request.